and non-existent, may have made the continuation of privileges arising from such treaties as moot. Accepting the Chinese proposal to re-designate the Indian Mission also eroded India's negotiating position since it accepted, by implication, that Tibet was not truly autonomous but a part of China. India's privileges became politically unviable and legally indefensible. India would go into the final negotiations in 1954 with a weak hand, having given up almost all the tactical advantages that it had held before 1950.

With the legal status of Tibet as part of China no longer in doubt after the 17-Point Agreement, with China having gained physical control over Tibet as far south as the Chumbi Valley and other areas along the India–China (Tibet) frontier, and with India having agreed to the principle that earlier treaties were no longer in existence, China unfolded the final leg of its strategy on Tibet. The Chinese had set two final tasks for themselves—to eliminate all historical privileges given to India and Nepal under the now defunct treaties, and to ensure that China's neighbours established normal ties with China by, presumably, accepting that Tibet was a part of China. [29] In line with these objectives, from late 1952, the Chinese started to apply pressure on India by protesting about certain activities by the Indian trade agents inside Tibet—for instance, alleging that they were distributing anti-China material—and through systematic harassment of Indian facilities and personnel. Their pressure focused, in particular, on the one area where India still held some advantage, its military escorts in Tibet. The Chinese began to accuse the Indian military personnel of bringing into Tibet a disproportionate number of guns that were beyond the legitimate needs of self-defence and in violation of international law. They hinted that this may be part of an arms smuggling operation to help the Tibetan resistance. They forcibly confiscated the wireless receiver and transmitter of the